SWRS Southwest Recovery Services

Providing Creative Solutions to Common Problems

UNPAID LEGAL FEES · CAPABILITIES OVERVIEW

Receivables Recovery for Law Firms

Recovering unpaid fees from former clients — on pure contingency, worked with the discretion a family practice requires

Prepared for **Scott M. Brown & Associates** · August 2026

01 — INTRODUCTION

A recovery partner for the fees that never followed the final decree

To Briana and the team at Scott M. Brown & Associates — thank you for reaching out. Family law carries a collection problem almost no other practice area does: the client owes you for the hardest year of their life, the matter is over, and the one thing they want is never to think about it again.

You told us the firm is carrying $100,000 to $499,000 in outstanding receivables. Across four offices and eight counties that is not a billing oversight — it is the accumulated residue of matters that closed faster than the fees were paid.

Southwest Recovery Services is an outsourced receivables recovery partner working these balances on **pure contingency since 2004**. You place through a secure portal and we work them. No recovery, no fee — so a book you have already written down costs nothing to test.

02 — AT A GLANCE

Two decades of recovery — nationwide

A documented, compliant process and the follow-up capacity a firm cannot staff internally without pulling people off billable work.

2004 Recovering commercial receivables since	**$975M+** Receivables placed (all industries)	**$76M+** Recovered for clients	**800K+** Accounts worked
52% of placed accounts see a recovery	**50** states — nationwide recovery reach	**4.9★** Google client rating	**$0** upfront — no recovery, no fee

- Commercial & B2B collections since 2004
- Nationwide — all 50 states
- 12 offices across 7 states
- Skip tracing on businesses & principals
- Contingency — no recovery, no fee

RECOGNIZED & FEATURED BY

USA TODAY · FINANCIAL SERVICES Review · FSR • TOP 10 LIST 2025 Recognition · INTERNATIONAL Business Times · CFO Tech Outlook · insideARM

ACCREDITED & RECOGNIZED

BETTER BUSINESS BUREAU · ACA INTERNATIONAL The Association of Credit and Collection Professionals Member · TOP COLLECTIONS COMPANY Clutch UNITED STATES 2026 · CHAMBER OF COMMERCE.COM 26 27 A+RATED BUSINESS · ★ 4.9 · 38 Google reviews

Memberships: **ACA International** · TAA · AAGD · NARPM

03 — YOUR QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

What a firm should ask before placing

Including the two answers most agencies avoid giving a law firm.

YOUR QUESTION	SOUTHWEST RECOVERY SERVICES
1. Fee structure	Pure contingency — $0 upfront, no retainer, no minimum. You pay a pre-agreed percentage only of what we recover. On a book this size that matters: the accounts you have already reserved against cost nothing to attempt.
2. What recovery on your fees actually looks like	Straight answer, because you will check it. It depends entirely on who owes. Fees owed by former family-law clients recover around 10–11% — those clients are often financially depleted by the matter itself. Fees owed by businesses, from commercial litigation or probate work, recover at 21–28% in our book. We would place those as two separate books rather than quote you one blended average.
3. How your former clients are treated	Every contact is calm, compliant and documented — FDCPA and Reg F by design. Your firm's reputation in Brazoria County is an asset built over twenty-four years; a collector who bullies a former client in a small county puts that at risk, and puts a bar complaint in play. That is why the tone is not negotiable.
4. Disputed fees	A fee dispute pauses recovery. We validate against the engagement letter and itemized billing record, and where a client raises a genuine service objection we hand it back to you rather than argue quality of representation on your behalf.
Four offices, one process	Angleton, Pearland, League City and Sugar Land place through one portal with office-level reporting.

THE SWRS CLIENT PORTAL

Simple placement, full visibility

Every placement runs through our secure portal — place a batch in minutes and see status without chasing anyone.

BILLING-EXPORT PLACEMENT

Upload an aging or A/R export from your billing system — we map your columns, no re-keying.

SECURE FILE EXCHANGE

Send engagement letters, itemized invoices and the billing record safely inside the portal — the documentation that carries a fee claim.

REAL-TIME REPORTING

Run and export account and recovery reports on demand, by office or across the firm.

DIRECT-PAYMENT REPORTING

Log payments a former client sends the firm directly, so balances stay accurate and nobody is contacted after paying.

► Portal Video Tour

SWRS Professional-Services Recovery Case Studies

Actual placed-versus-recovered results from Southwest Recovery's professional-services book, anonymized. They are split deliberately, because the split is the most useful thing on this page: fees owed by a BUSINESS recover at two to three times the rate of fees owed by an INDIVIDUAL. Your firm has both kinds of receivable, and they should not be placed with the same expectations.

CONSULTING FIRM — BUSINESS DEBTORS

Advisory practice

$21.4K recovered

of ~$78K placed

28% recovered

ENGINEERING FIRM — BUSINESS DEBTORS

Civil engineering practice

$28.4K recovered

of ~$119K placed

24% recovered

ADVISORY FIRM — BUSINESS DEBTORS

Professional advisory group

$24.0K recovered

of ~$113K placed

21% recovered

CPA PRACTICE — MIXED DEBTORS

Accounting practice

$2.3K recovered

of ~$10K placed

23% recovered

FAMILY LAW FIRM — CONSUMER DEBTORS

Multi-office family practice

$121.3K recovered

of ~$1.13M placed

11% recovered

FAMILY LAW FIRM — CONSUMER DEBTORS

Established family practice

$40.4K recovered

of ~$396K placed

10% recovered

Anonymized by sector from Southwest Recovery's book; individual client names withheld. Results vary by account age, balance, documentation quality and industry. We do not publish blended portfolio averages.

THE SPLIT IS THE STRATEGY

Place your business-owed fees and your client-owed fees as two different books

Family-law fees are owed by individuals who are often financially depleted by the matter itself, and they recover around 10–11%. Fees owed by a business — commercial litigation, probate and estate work, corporate clients — behave like commercial receivables and recover at 21–28%. Placed together they look like one mediocre result; placed separately, each gets the approach it needs.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE FIRM

The consumer book is a volume play: modest percentage, meaningful cash, zero cost. The business-owed book deserves to be placed first, because it is worth more per dollar placed.

WHAT RAISES BOTH

Placing sooner after the matter closes, a complete engagement letter and itemized billing record, and current contact details captured at intake rather than reconstructed later.

Recovery figures vary by portfolio; SWRS gives an honest, age-based read on a representative sample before any accounts are worked.

05 — BUILT FOR LAW FIRMS

We speak your ledger

A family practice’s receivables behave unlike any other professional service. Our playbook is built for that.

Post-matter fee balances

Fees owed once representation has ended, pursued against the engagement letter and itemized billing record.

Former clients who have moved on

Skip tracing to re-establish contact after a divorce has changed address, phone, employer and often name.

Credit reporting

Reportable balances go to Equifax and Experian — leverage a firm has no practical way to apply itself.

Reputation-safe contact

Compliant, documented, unaggressive outreach in the counties where the firm’s name carries weight.

06 — AI-POWERED COLLECTIONS

Recovery run on an AI-driven platform — Aktos

Every account SWRS works runs on Aktos, a next-generation, AI-driven collections platform — with compliance built into the workflow, not bolted on afterward. It's how a boutique, people-first agency delivers enterprise-grade speed, consistency, and auditability.

AKTOS

AI workflow automation

Repetitive steps are automated and every account is scored and routed by predicted payment likelihood — so the right strategy reaches the right account first, without manual queue-picking.

Omnichannel outreach

Coordinated email, SMS, and voice, timed to when a debtor is most likely to engage — replacing high-friction call blasts with respectful, data-driven contact.

Compliance built in

FDCPA, Reg F, and TCPA guardrails are enforced inside the automation, with phone-number and consent checks before outreach — documented and defensible on every account.

Real-time dashboards

You see status, segmentation, and recovery performance on your portfolio in real time — full transparency, not a monthly PDF.

Data-driven scoring

Dynamic scoring and segmentation predict payment likelihood and concentrate effort where recovery is most achievable — earlier intervention that returns more of each aging balance and reduces disputes.

The result is the combination clients rarely get from a legacy agency: faster cash and cleaner compliance at once. Automation standardizes documentation while empathy-first contact protects your brand and keeps disputes low.

07 — MEET THE FOUNDER

Built by a collector with 30 years on the phones — not a CEO with zero collection experience

Steven Dietz

Founder & Chief Executive Officer

Featured in USA Today, International Business Times & Financial Services Review — Top AR Management Service, 2025 · ACA International member.

Steven Dietz didn't come to collections from the corner office — he came from the phones. He started as a collector and credit analyst before he was 20, trained collectors across 100+ locations for Aaron's, and has spent nearly 30 years in receivables.

He founded Southwest Recovery Services in 2004 on one principle: the industry's bad reputation is a choice, not a requirement. Two decades on he still coaches the teams and works accounts personally.

> "Regardless of the means of recovery, our focus is always on preserving goodwill and representing the client professionally.
>
> **— Steven Dietz, Founder & Chief Executive Officer, Southwest Recovery Services**

A former client of a family law firm has already been through the worst year of their life. Recovery stays firm, compliant and quiet — that protects the client, and it protects a reputation built in Brazoria County since 2002.

08 — RESOURCES

Take it with you

Download this overview and the supporting white papers to share with your team.

This capabilities overview

PDF · prepared for Scott M. Brown & Associates

Download PDF ↓

The Placement-File Standard

Maximizing recovery · PDF

Download PDF ↓

Fair Debt Collection Practices — What Businesses Should Know

Consumer balances · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Aktos Advantage

Our AI-driven collections platform · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Experian Intelligence Advantage

Data & skip-tracing stack · PDF

Download PDF ↓

The Recovery Waterfall

Full recovery lifecycle · PDF

Download PDF ↓

09 — NEXT STEP

Let’s put an honest number against your outstanding fees.

A 30-minute call with Hunter Howard to walk the aging across all four offices, review what documentation the firm holds, and put a contingency rate against a representative sample.

Book a 30-minute discovery call →

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